



Scoliosis Research Society
555 E. Wells St., Suite 1100
Milwaukee, WI 53202
Phone: +1-414-289-9107

Program Reviewer Guidelines and Procedures

As a program reviewer, you are providing an independent, un-biased review of a potential CME program and we are relying on your expertise to validate the program content and to ensure it is free from commercial bias. Please note the following guidelines.

1. "CME consists of educational activities which serve to maintain, develop, or increase the knowledge, skills, professional competence and relationships a physician uses to provide services for patients, the public, or the profession. The content of CME is the body of knowledge and skills generally recognized and accepted by the profession as within the basic medical sciences, the discipline of clinical medical and the provision of health care to the public."
2. All recommendations involving clinical medicine in a CME activity must be based on evidence that is accepted with the profession of medicine as adequate justification for their indication or contraindications in the care of patients.
3. All scientific research referred to, reported or used in a CME activity in support or justification of a patient care recommendation must conform to the generally accepted standards of experimental design, data collection and analysis.
4. All recommendations, treatment, or manners of practicing medicine discussed in a CME activity must be within the definition of CME and must not be known (a) to have risks or dangers that outweigh the benefits or (b) to be ineffective in the treatment of patients.
5. It is our policy to ensure balance, independence, objectivity, and scientific rigor in all sponsored or jointly sponsored educational programs. In accordance with the Accreditation Council for Continuing Medical Education's Standards for Integrity and Independence in Accredited Continuing Education, all planners, teachers, and faculty, authors or reviewers involved in the development or presentation of CME content are required to disclose to the accredited provider their relevant financial relationships.
6. Participation: Individuals who fail or refuse to disclose their relevant financial relationship(s) will be prohibited from participation in the planning, presentation, or evaluation of a CME activity. The ACCME requires CME providers to mitigate relevant financial relationships before an individual may participate in the development or presentation of a CME activity.



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SRS CME Policies

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Relevant Financial Relationships

Financial relationships of any dollar amount are defined as relevant if the educational content is related to the business lines or products of an ineligible company*.

Disclosure Process

All presenters are required to disclose all financial relationships with ineligible companies* within the prior 24 months. Individuals must disclose all financial relationships, regardless of the amount.

Items to be disclosed must include:

- a. The name of the ineligible company* with which the person has a financial relationship.
- b. The nature of the financial relationship. Examples of financial relationships include employee, researcher, consultant, advisor, speaker, independent contractor (including contracted research), royalties or patent beneficiary, executive role, and ownership interest. Individual stocks and stock options should be disclosed; diversified mutual funds do not need to be disclosed. Research funding from ineligible companies should be disclosed by the principal or named investigator even if that individual's institution receives the research grant and manages the funds.

Any deliberate failure to disclose financial relationships and other actions related to maintenance of full disclosure can lead to disciplinary action or warning.

Product-Specific Language

SRS strongly prefers that pharmaceuticals and proprietary software/databases as well as surgical approaches or specific instrumentation such as "Surgimap, MIMICS, EOS Imaging, ROTEM, XLIF, DLIF, AxiaLIF, Solera, Vertex, Expedium, Mountaineer, VEPTR, Shilla, etc.," are not used in presentations. These terms should be replaced by a generic term or description of the drug, software/database and/or instrumentation or technique unless the use of the term directly impacts learners' understanding of the presentation or data. Instrumentation may also be referred to when the device name is a landmark system that is no longer sold (i.e. Harrington, Cotrel-Dubousset, Luque). It is recognized that studies evaluating a device or devices or comparing different devices or techniques may require the use of product or technique names. If a device trade name or industry developed technique using a trademarked name are used in an abstract or presentation, it will be specifically reviewed by the CME Committee for evaluation of any relevant financial relationships. When there is a known relevant financial relationship, expanded verbal disclosure will be necessary at the time of presentation. Furthermore, if a product name is mentioned, the audience should be informed of why it is necessary to give the name.

Review of Presentations

The CME committee reviews content from all presentations to determine if a relevant financial relationship is present. If a conflict is found, it is the responsibility of the CME committee to work with the presenter to mitigate the conflict prior to the activity. In an effort to mitigate these conflicts, the CME Committee can request presentation slides prior to a presentation.

- If a slide review is necessary, the decision resulting from that review will be binding and the presenter must make all changes requested.
- If those changes are not made, then the presentation will be removed from the program.
- If the presentation is given without approved edits, then disciplinary action will be taken.

Disciplinary Action

Disciplinary action can be taken when a presenter does not make required edits to a presentation OR if the presentation is judged to be biased by the CME committee after an investigation, to include video review, moderator input and evaluation review. A bias investigation will be launched in the event of moderator bias notation and/or bias notation in the speaker evaluations if the speaker and/or authors has a relationship with the ineligible company.

Disciplinary action will be left to the discretion of the committee and can include ban of up to three years for invited presentations and one year for abstract presentations at SRS CME events.

If a presenter wishes to contest disciplinary action taken by the CME Committee, they may do so by an appeal hearing to the Non-Conflicted Sub-Committee. The decision of the Sub-Committee is binding and final.

Any repeat offenses will automatically result in disciplinary action without appeal. All disciplinary action takes effect immediately after the final decision is rendered. All CME violation issues must be taken care of by December 31st of the event year.

**An ineligible company is defined as one whose primary business is producing, marketing, selling, re-selling, or distributing healthcare products used by or on patients.*